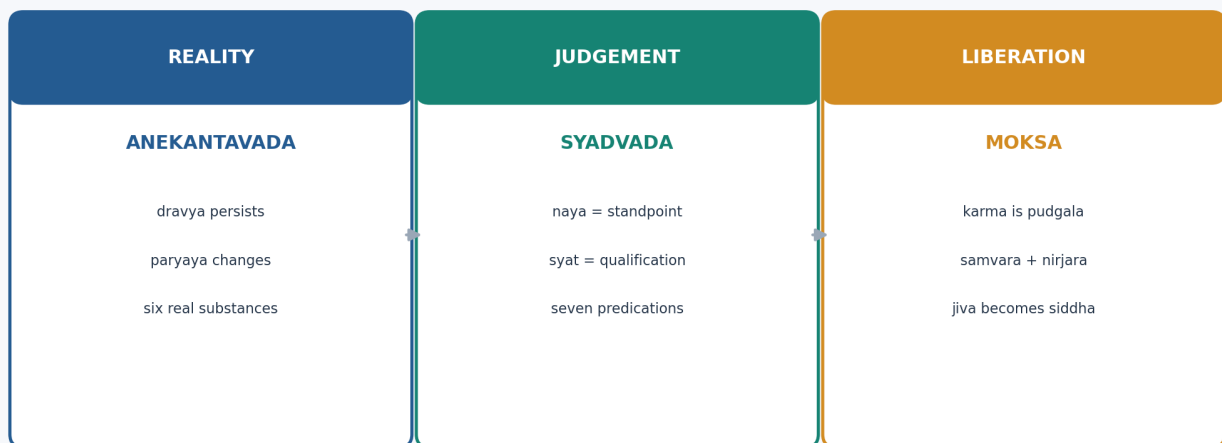


JAINISM - Syllabus Item 13 (Paper I - Section B)

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

JAINISM: MANY-SIDED REALITY, QUALIFIED SPEECH, LIBERATION



sat = origination + decay + permanence

Metaphysics grounds logic; disciplined conduct stops influx and sheds material karma.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

JAINISM - Syllabus Item 13 (Paper I - Section B)

8. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.
2019	Q6(a)	20 marks	How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.
2020	Q5(a)	10 marks	Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?
2021	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'.
2022	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.
2022	Q6(b)	15 marks	'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.
2023	Q5(a)	10 marks	"All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.
2024	Q6(c)	15 marks	What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha and Dravyabandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.
2025	Q7(c)	15 marks	Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) ANALYSIS:

9.1 10-mark answer

Define the key term precisely: anekāntavāda, syādvāda, karma, or bhāvabandha.
 Give the doctrinal core in 3–4 compact points.
 Add one distinction that prevents confusion (e.g., anekāntavāda vs syādvāda).
 Close with one evaluative line or exam-relevant implication.

9.2 15-mark answer

Frame the issue: Jainism balances realism with non-absolutism.
 Body A: explain the doctrine requested (reality / sevenfold judgement / bondage).
 Body B: add structure—tables, ordered seven predicates, or bondage sequence.
 Body C: include one criticism and one reply.
 Conclude with a clear philosophical verdict, not mere summary.

9.3 20-mark answer

Open by linking metaphysics and judgement: many-sided reality requires qualified predication.
 Section 1: define reality via dravya, guṇa, paryāya, utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya.
 Section 2: show reflection in nayavāda, syādvāda, saptabhaṅgī.
 Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, karma, and liberation.
 Section 4: critically assess pluralism, realism, and self-refutation objections.
 End with a balanced conclusion: realism without dogmatism.

10. LINK-OUTS

- Carvaka.md
- Buddhism.md
- Vedanta.md
- Pramāṇa across schools
- Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique
- Indian Philosophy PYQ bank, 2018–2025

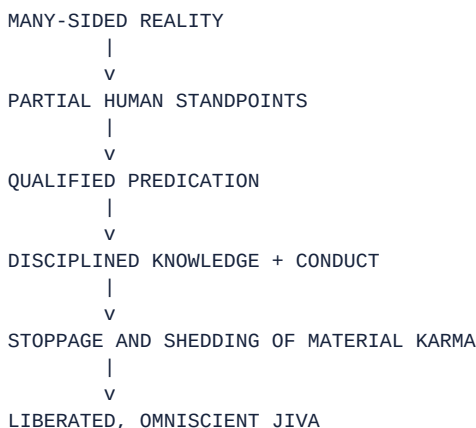
SOURCES

- *Tattvārthasūtra* / *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* (named without invented sūtra numbers).
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I.

PART II - COMPLETE SOLVED PRACTICE

Learning Design and Source Grounding

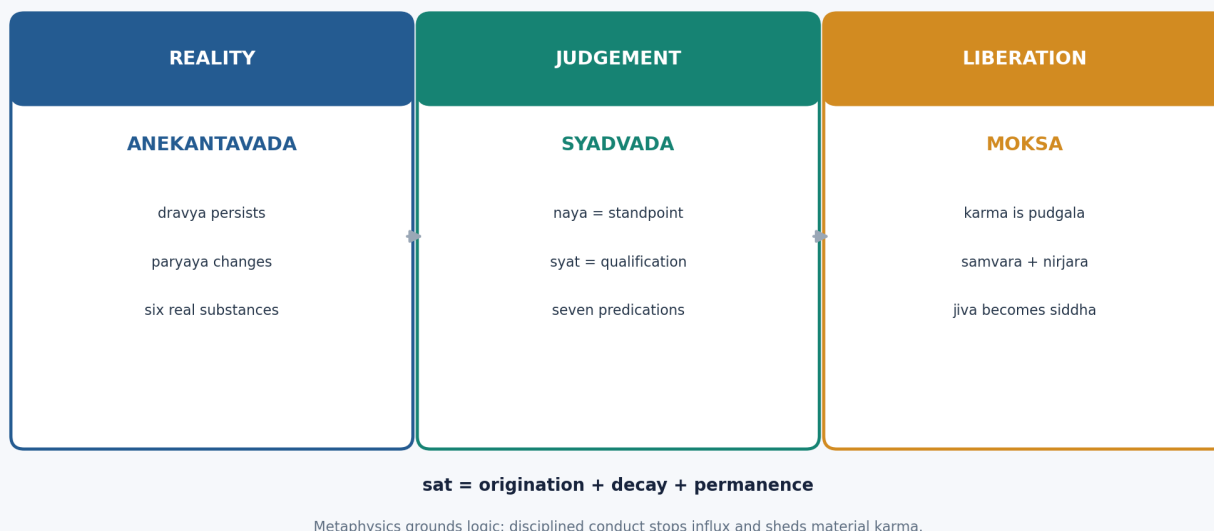
This package uses the canonical owner above, the complete 2018-2025 PYQ audit, Chatterjee and Datta's chapter on Jaina philosophy, and C. D. Sharma's critical treatment. The central learning design follows the actual doctrinal dependence:



Master distinction: *Anekantavada* is the metaphysics, *nayavada* is the standpoint discipline, *syadvada* is the rule of conditional predication, and *saptabhangi* is the sevenfold formal expansion.

Visual - The Three-Pillar System

JAINISM: MANY-SIDED REALITY, QUALIFIED SPEECH, LIBERATION



Jainism: many-sided reality, qualified judgement, and liberation

The same realism that permits permanence and change also explains why finite judgements require qualification and why bondage can be removed without destroying the enduring soul.

Rapid Retrieval Matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>sat = utpada + vyaya + dhrauvya</i>
Ontology	six <i>dravyas</i> ; five <i>astikayas</i> plus time
Cognition	five knowledges; finite knowledge is karmically obstructed
Standpoints	substance, mode, general, particular, conventional, etymological, actual usage
Sevenfold judgement	is; is not; both successively; inexpressible; three combinations with inexpressibility
Bondage	passions cause psychic bondage and attract subtle karmic matter
Liberation	<i>asrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjara -> moksa</i>
Path	right vision + right knowledge + right conduct

SOLVED PYQ WORKBOOK - ALL 9 VERIFIED QUESTIONS

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: How do the Jaina philosophers explain bondage? What is the distinction between liberated soul and bound soul? What is the condition of the liberated soul?

Model solution

Jainism explains bondage as the real association of conscious *jiva* with subtle material *karma-pudgala*. The soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, but passions and activities obstruct these powers.

The mechanism has two inseparable dimensions. **Bhavabandha** is the psychic condition of delusion, attachment and the four *kasayas* - anger, pride, deceit and greed. It makes the soul adhesive. **Dravyabandha** is the actual influx and binding of karmic particles to the soul. Chatterjee and Datta therefore say bondage begins in thought: inner passion guides the material embodiment acquired by the soul.

Bound soul	Liberated soul
embodied and co-extensive with a body	bodiless <i>siddha</i>
knowledge obscured by karmas	<i>kevala-jnana</i> fully manifest
subject to birth, pleasure, pain and death	beyond rebirth and suffering
contracts or expands with embodiment	rises to <i>siddha-sila</i>
possesses active karmic accretions	all karmas destroyed

Liberation requires stopping new influx through *samvara* and exhausting old karma through *nirjara*, guided by the three jewels. The liberated soul retains numerical individuality; moksha is not merger into Brahman or extinction of the person.

Critical qualification: The account preserves moral continuity through a permanent agent, but the interaction of non-material consciousness with material karma remains difficult.

Why this earns marks: It answers all three limbs, distinguishes psychic and material bondage, names the causal sequence, and states the liberated condition without importing Vedanta.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory reflected in their view on judgements?

Model solution

Jaina philosophy defines the real as what possesses **origination, decay and permanence** together: *utpada-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktam sat*. A real substance persists through changing modes. This avoids the extremes of immutable monism and Buddhist pure flux.

Reality consists of six irreducible *dravyas*: conscious *jiva* and the five forms of *ajiva* - matter, media of motion and rest, space and time. Every substance has stable *gunas* and changing *pariyayas*. A gold ornament, for example, persists materially while bracelet-mode ceases and ring-mode originates. Hence reality is **anekanta**, many-sided.

Finite cognition normally grasps one aspect at a time. **Nayavada** identifies legitimate but partial standpoints; an error occurs when a partial truth is absolutised. **Syadvada** therefore prefixes predication with *syat*, "in some respect" or "conditionally". Its sevenfold expansion states:

1. somehow it is;
2. somehow it is not;
3. somehow it is and is not, successively and in different respects;
4. somehow it is inexpressible;
5. somehow it is and is inexpressible;
6. somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
7. somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

The jar exists as its present substance and mode, does not exist as another object or at another time, and becomes inexpressible when incompatible temporal-modal aspects are demanded in one simple utterance.

Shankara objects that opposite predicates cannot belong to one real and that conditional truth presupposes an unconditional doctrine. The Jaina reply is that predicates are indexed to standpoint, respect and time; contradiction arises only when these qualifications are suppressed. Omniscient knowledge apprehends the whole, while ordinary statements remain partial.

Verdict: Jaina judgement is not sceptical relativism but the linguistic discipline demanded by a pluralistic realism. Its strength is anti-dogmatism; its vulnerability is explaining the absolute status of *anekanta* and omniscience.

Why this earns marks: It links metaphysics to logic, reproduces all seven predications in order, uses a worked example, and adjudicates the absolutism objection.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon liberation?

Model solution

Jainism treats karma not merely as moral law but as **subtle material pudgala** attracted to the soul by bodily, verbal and mental activity under passion. Delusion and the four *kasayas* make the soul receptive; karmic matter then obscures its intrinsic knowledge, perception, energy and bliss.

The doctrine directly structures liberation. *Asrava* is influx, *bandha* binding, *samvara* stoppage of new karma, and *nirjara* shedding of accumulated karma. Right vision, knowledge and conduct, together with vows and austerity, weaken passion, stop fresh influx and mature or burn existing karmas. When all eight basic karma-types are destroyed, *kevala-jnana* manifests and the soul becomes a liberated *siddha*.

The theory gives ethical acts an objective continuity without a creator God. Its difficulty is explanatory: material particles affecting immaterial consciousness look category-crossing, and beginningless bondage is asserted rather than historically explained.

Verdict: Karma is the material mechanism that makes Jaina soteriology a liberation by subtraction.

Why this earns marks: It defines material karma, supplies the five-stage sequence, connects practice to metaphysics, and includes a precise criticism.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (*sapta-bhangi*) Naya.

Model solution

The sevenfold judgement is the logical expression of Jaina many-sided realism. *Naya* is a partial standpoint; *syat* qualifies a proposition by respect, time, relation or mode. Since a finite judgement cannot exhaust a real, predication must remain conditional.

The seven forms are:

Form	Meaning
<i>syad asti</i>	in some respect, it is
<i>syad nasti</i>	in some respect, it is not
<i>syad asti ca nasti ca</i>	in different respects/successive moments, it is and is not
<i>syad avaktavyam</i>	in some respect, it is inexpressible
<i>syad asti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is and is inexpressible
<i>syad nasti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is not and is inexpressible
<i>syad asti ca nasti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is, is not and is inexpressible

A jar exists as a jar here and now, does not exist as cloth or in a destroyed future state, and is inexpressible when its mutually indexed aspects are demanded simultaneously in one unqualified assertion.

The theory does not assert brute contradictions. "Is" and "is not" concern different aspects. Nor is *avaktavya* mere ignorance: it marks the inability of one simple sentence to state complex, temporally differentiated reality at once.

Critics call the scheme redundant or self-defeating. The Jaina reply is that seven possibilities systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility, disciplining speech rather than multiplying truth-values arbitrarily.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is best read as standpoint-conditioned predication grounded in realism, not as unrestricted relativism.

Why this earns marks: It defines the doctrinal chain, gives the exact ordered seven, applies an example, and blocks the contradiction caricature.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Jaina soteriology depends on its material conception of karma. The soul is intrinsically omniscient and blissful, yet passions attract subtle karmic matter that obscures these powers. Thus liberation is not divine grace or knowledge of an already non-dual identity; it is the actual removal of material obstruction.

The sequence is *asrava* -> *bandha* -> *samvara* -> *nirjara* -> *moksa*. Ethical vows, non-violence, restraint and the three jewels stop fresh influx; austerity and passionlessness shed accumulated karma. Destruction of knowledge-obscuring karma reveals *kevala-jnana*, and the fully purified soul rises as an individual *siddha*.

The theory strongly integrates metaphysics, ethics and personal responsibility without a creator. Yet material karma binding a conscious soul is obscure, and if bondage is beginningless the transition from original purity to obstruction is never explained.

Verdict: Karma gives Jainism a rigorous technology of self-purification, though its literal materialism creates the system's deepest interaction problem.

Why this earns marks: It focuses on "bearing", names the operational sequence, links vows to mechanisms, and balances explanatory gain with cost.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: "The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating Absolutism." Critically examine.

Model solution

The objection targets a possible self-reference problem. If every claim is only relatively true, the claim "every claim is relative" must itself be relative and cannot govern all judgements. Moreover, Jaina philosophy treats *anekantavada*, the reality of substances and *kevala-jnana* as more than merely optional perspectives. C. D. Sharma therefore argues that Jainism makes an exception for its own teaching.

The criticism is powerful against a crude reading of Jainism as "all views are equally true". Classical Jainism, however, is a **realist non-absolutism**, not sceptical relativism. Reality objectively has many aspects; a *naya* is true insofar as it tracks one of them and false when absolutised. *Syat* indexes a statement to conditions; it does not dissolve its truth.

The Jaina may concede two levels. Finite discursive cognition is partial because karmic obstruction limits the knower. Omniscient *kevala-jnana* comprehends all aspects together. The unconditional thesis required is therefore minimal: reality exceeds every finite unqualified judgement. It need not be an absolutist proposition exhaustively describing reality.

Still, the reply carries a cost. If an omniscient standpoint validates the system, its existence needs independent support; otherwise it is introduced to rescue relativity. Further, the assertion that every real has substance and modes appears itself universal.

Verdict: Jainism cannot avoid all absoluteness, but it need not. Its coherent position is qualified realism: objective many-sidedness plus the fallibility of finite predication, not the absolute thesis that nothing is absolute.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs the self-reference objection, distinguishes relativism from non-absolutism, presents the omniscience reply, and concedes the residual burden.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina sevenfold judgement in this light.

Model solution

Jainism agrees that ordinary embodied knowledge is limited and standpoint-bound, but it does not reduce all knowledge to sensory empiricism. Its fivefold scheme includes *mati* and *sruta* as indirect ordinary knowledge, while *avadhi*, *manahpariyaya* and *kevala* transcend normal sense mediation.

Sevenfold judgement governs finite discursive assertion. Because reality includes enduring substance and changing modes, "the jar exists" is true from one time, place and respect; "the jar does not exist" is true relative to another object, time or mode. The seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility prevent a partial empirical judgement from becoming absolute.

The proposition in the question is therefore only partly Jaina. Human embodied cognition is commonly relative, but *kevala-jnana* is direct, complete and non-relative. Critics may say this exception is ad hoc. The Jaina replies that omniscience is the manifestation of the soul's intrinsic cognition after karmic obstruction ends.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is a discipline for finite empirical knowledge, not the final theory of every possible cognition.

Why this earns marks: It tests the quotation rather than accepting it, links knowledge classification to judgement, and identifies the kevala qualification.

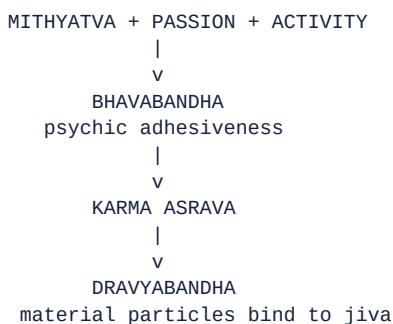
Solved PYQ 8 - 2024 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: What is the distinction between Bhavabandha and Dravyabandha?

Model solution

Jainism distinguishes the psychic cause of bondage from its material embodiment. **Bhavabandha** is the internal state of the soul: wrong vision, ignorance, attachment and the *kasayas* of anger, pride, deceit and greed. **Dravyabandha** is the actual binding of subtle karmic matter to the soul.

The relation is causal rather than merely classificatory:



The distinction explains why bondage begins "in thought" while still producing real bodies, capacities and experiences. It also structures release: right vision and conduct remove the affective conditions, producing *samvara*; austerity and equanimity promote *nirjara* of already bound karma.

The four parameters of material bondage - type, duration, intensity and quantity - show that inner passion shapes the exact karmic result. Thus ethics is not external obedience but causal transformation of the soul's condition.

Critically, the two-level theory avoids reducing morality either to mental intention or physical mechanism. Its weakness is the unexplained bridge by which a non-material affect attracts material particles.

Why this earns marks: It defines both terms, shows their direction of dependence, connects them to release, and evaluates the category-crossing mechanism.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Jaina philosophy is pluralistic because it recognises infinitely many individual *jivas* and five irreducible forms of *ajiva*, classified as six *dravyas*. It is realistic because these substances, their qualities and modes exist independently of being known. *Anekantavada* does not make reality a construction of language; it states that the real itself has many aspects.

Pluralism is disciplined rather than chaotic. Each substance has a distinct function: *pudgala* is material, *dharma* and *adharma* enable motion and rest, space accommodates, and time orders succession. Every real combines persistence and change through *dravya-guna-paryaya*. Hence Jainism rejects both monistic reduction and momentary flux.

Its theory of judgement follows the realism. *Nayas* select objective aspects; *syadvada* qualifies assertions; sevenfold judgement prevents one-sided predicates from masquerading as complete descriptions. Truth is perspective-conditioned but not merely subjective.

Critics raise three costs. Shankara argues opposed predicates threaten non-contradiction. Buddhist critics reject an enduring substance beneath modes. C. D. Sharma argues that combining partial truths does not automatically yield

whole truth and that Jainism absolutises its own relativity. Jaina replies distinguish respects and times, and reserve total cognition for *kevala-jnana*.

Verdict: Jainism is best classified as **pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism**. Its ontology is robustly objective; relativity belongs chiefly to finite predication. Its residual burden is to justify the omniscient standpoint and the unity of permanence with change.

Why this earns marks: It answers both labels, proves them through the six dravyas and objective modes, connects logic to ontology, and engages three named criticisms.

Integrated MCQ Loop - 24 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Reality according to Jainism is: A. origination, decay and permanence together B. pure permanence C. pure flux D. mental construction	A	The formula preserves identity and change.
2	Which is a dravya but not an astikaya? A. jiva B. kala C. akasa D. pudgala	B	Time lacks the many-space-point extension of an astikaya.
3	Anekantavada is primarily: A. ethics B. scepticism C. metaphysical many-sidedness D. ritual pluralism	C	It concerns the structure of reality.
4	Syadvada is: A. denial of truth B. omniscience C. substance theory D. conditional predication	D	"Syat" indexes assertion to a respect.
5	Nayavada teaches that: A. standpoints are partial but may be valid B. all views are false C. only scripture is true D. language is impossible	A	Error comes from absolutising a partial standpoint.
6	The second sevenfold predicate is: A. somehow it is B. somehow it is not C. it is inexpressible D. it is and is not	B	The sequence begins affirmation, negation, then both.
7	Avaktavya chiefly marks: A. ignorance alone B. falsehood C. inability of one simple utterance to state complex aspects simultaneously D. silence as liberation	C	It is a semantic-modal limitation.
8	Ordinary human knowledge is limited mainly by: A. divine decree B. language alone C. non-existence of objects D. karmic obstruction	D	Knowledge is intrinsic but obscured.
9	Karma in Jainism is: A. subtle material pudgala B. divine punishment C. memory D. mere intention	A	It physically binds to the jiva.
10	Bhavabandha is: A. a liberated state B. psychic bondage through passions C. karmic particle only D. bodily death	B	It is the internal adhesive condition.
11	Dravyabandha is: A. ignorance only B. a vow C. actual material karmic binding D. omniscience	C	Karmic particles attach to the soul.
12	Stoppage of new influx is: A. asrava B. bandha C. nirjara D. samvara	D	Nirjara removes already accumulated karma.
13	The three jewels begin with: A. right vision B. austerity C. omniscience D. non-possession only	A	Vision, knowledge and conduct form the path.
14	Complete knowledge is: A. mati B. kevala-jnana C. sruta D. avadhi	B	It manifests when obscuring karmas are destroyed.
15	The liberated soul: A. merges into Brahman B. becomes momentary C. remains an individual siddha D. creates the world	C	Numerical individuality is retained.
16	Dharma-dravya means: A. moral merit B. scripture C. karma D. medium enabling motion	D	It is not ethical dharma.
17	Adharma-dravya means: A. medium enabling rest B. sin C. non-being D. obstruction karma	A	It enables rest as water enables fish movement analogically.
18	The blind-men-and-elephant analogy illustrates: A. material karma B. partial standpoints C. creator God D. momentariness	B	Each perspective captures an aspect.
19	Jaina realism differs from Madhyamaka because it: A. denies language B. denies all substance C. affirms real substances with modes D. accepts a creator	C	Anekanta is not emptiness of all essence.
20	Shankara's central logical objection is: A. too few dravyas B. karma is moral C. vows are impossible D. opposed predicates threaten contradiction	D	The Jaina reply indexes them to different respects.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
21	Sallekhana is ideally: A. passionless thinning at life's appropriate end B. impulsive suicide C. punishment D. sacrifice to God	A	Intention and absence of passion are decisive.
22	Five astikayas plus which sixth dravya? A. karma B. time C. liberation D. omniscience	B	Kala completes the sixfold list.
23	The four kasayas include anger, pride, deceit and: A. fear B. pleasure C. greed D. doubt	C	These passions intensify bondage.
24	The best classification of Jainism is: A. subjective idealism B. nihilism C. monism D. pluralistic realism with non-absolutist predication	D	Reality is objective and many-sided.

Rotation audit: A -> B -> C -> D repeated six times.

Remedial MCQ Loop - 8 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Correction
25	Anekantavada and syadvada are: A. metaphysical basis and linguistic-logical expression B. synonyms without distinction C. rival sects D. vows	A	Reality's many-sidedness grounds qualified speech.
26	"Somehow it is and is not" means: A. contradiction in one respect B. affirmation and negation under different respects/times C. truth is impossible D. the object is imaginary	B	Qualifications block contradiction.
27	Karma is attracted principally because of: A. space B. God C. passion joined with activity D. time alone	C	Bhavabandha makes the soul adhesive.
28	Nirjara means: A. influx B. binding C. right vision D. shedding accumulated karma	D	It complements samvara.
29	Jainism's soul is: A. permanent through changing modes B. a five-skandha stream C. Brahman D. body alone	A	It is a real individual substance.
30	"All knowledge is relative" must be qualified because Jainism admits: A. only perception B. kevala-jnana C. no knowledge D. divine revelation	B	Omniscience is non-relative.
31	Dharma and adharma dravyas are: A. merit and sin B. souls C. media of motion and rest D. creation and destruction	C	Moral meanings are a trap here.
32	The strongest residual criticism of material karma is: A. it lacks ethical effects B. it requires God C. it denies conduct D. matter-consciousness interaction is obscure	D	The causal bridge remains difficult.

Original Mains Practice

Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish anekantavada, nayavada and syadvada.

Model solution

The three doctrines form a dependence relation rather than a list of synonyms. **Anekantavada** is ontological: every real has multiple aspects because substance persists while modes change. **Nayavada** is epistemological: a finite knower approaches that complex real from a partial standpoint. **Syadvada** is semantic-logical: every finite assertion should be qualified by *syat*, "in some respect".

A gold ornament illustrates the sequence. The real includes enduring gold and changing ring or bracelet modes. A substantial standpoint stresses continuity; a modal standpoint stresses alteration. "The ornament exists" is therefore

true relative to its present form and context, while "it does not exist" may be true as a bracelet after remaking.

Confusing the doctrines makes Jainism look like verbal relativism. The metaphysics grounds the standpoint; the standpoint grounds qualified predication.

Why this earns marks: It defines each level, shows the causal order, uses one coherent example and prevents the standard synonym error.

Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Does saptabhangi violate the law of non-contradiction?

Model solution

The law of non-contradiction forbids asserting P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect and at the same time. Saptabhangi does not intentionally do this. *Syad asti* and *syam nasti* index predicates to different times, relations, places or modes. A jar exists here as clay-jar now; it does not exist as cloth or as the destroyed future jar.

The third predicate combines affirmation and negation successively, not as an unqualified simultaneous contradiction. *Avaktavya* marks the inability of one simple utterance to express complex indexed aspects together. Thus the sevenfold scheme is a discipline of qualification.

Shankara's objection remains relevant when qualifications are omitted or when Jainism claims one subject literally possesses opposed essential attributes. The Jaina reply relies on the *dravya-paryaya* distinction: permanence belongs to substance, change to mode.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is compatible with non-contradiction under explicit indexing; it becomes incoherent only when "syat" is reduced to decorative uncertainty.

Why this earns marks: It states the formal law, tests the third and fourth predicates, presents Shankara's pressure, and gives the precise Jaina reply.

Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: "Jaina liberation is a metaphysics of purification rather than transformation." Analyse.

Model solution

The statement captures the Jaina view that the soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss. Bondage does not create a new essence; subtle karmic matter obscures the existing capacities of *jiva*. Liberation therefore removes obstruction rather than converting the soul into another substance.

The mechanism is systematic. Psychic bondage - wrong vision, ignorance and passion - attracts material karma. *Asrava* produces influx and *bandha* attachment. Right vision, knowledge and conduct generate *samvara*, while austerity and passionlessness produce *nirjara*. Destruction of obscuring karmas reveals *kevala-jnana*; destruction of all karma yields moksha.

Purification is nevertheless transformative at the level of modes. The embodied soul contracts or expands with bodies, experiences pleasure and pain, and advances through fourteen *gunasthanas*. The liberated *siddha* is bodiless, omniscient and beyond rebirth, though numerically the same soul. Hence substance persists while modes are radically altered - exactly the Jaina formula for reality.

The theory integrates ontology, ethics and soteriology without God. Its costs are the obscure interaction of soul and karmic matter, the unexplained beginninglessness of bondage, and dependence on the contested possibility of omniscience.

Verdict: Liberation is purification in substance and transformation in mode; the *dravya-paryaya* distinction allows Jainism to affirm both without identity-loss.

Why this earns marks: It interprets the quotation, reconstructs the full causal sequence, uses *gunasthanas* and *kevala-jnana*, and ends with a qualified synthesis.